

who are at Valve who want to work on that, I don't really see us moving to that platform".

He also expressed disappointment with how the PS3 version of The Orange Box turned out calling it a "stepchild" version of the game.

2.2 Microsoft Xbox 360

Microsoft's foray into the video game industry with the original Xbox wasn't as big a hit as the company would have wanted. Still, the potential was clearly seen, and as is the competitive way of MS, the second generation of its console was intended to beat the heavyweight PlayStation 3 and reign supreme in the console industry.

This wasn't going to be easy: Microsoft's core business has always been software while this was an out-and-out hardware venture. What's more, Sony enjoyed a special spot in the hearts of all game developers, given that the PlayStation 2 had quickly become the most popular console of all time.

Bill Gates and his merry men decided to place their trust in two visionaries for this next-gen device: Microsoft Vice President J Allard and the newly-hired Peter Moore, former President of Sega America. This partnership has been widely credited as the reason the Xbox 360 has emerged as the superior console among the two.



Microsoft's rush ended up with IBM making 90nm chips for the Xenon processor and ATI making 80nm chips for the Xenos GPU, taking up more physical space, more power and emitting more heat

2.2.1 HARDWARE

Xenon Processor

Just because Sony went to IBM to develop a next-generation processor did not mean that Microsoft was going to run in the opposite direction. IBM was the premier processor-maker on the planet and MS was looking for something state-of-the-art for the Xbox 360.

IBM was already working on the PowerPC architecture at that time, derived from the same designs that were going into making the Cell Processor. When Microsoft